

HOUSE RESOLUTION 164

By Faison

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Karen D. Williford Rogers of Mohawk.

WHEREAS, the members of this legislative body were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Karen D. Williford Rogers of Mohawk; and

WHEREAS, born on March 17, 1961, in Alexandria, Virginia, Karen Rogers graduated from East High School while simultaneously earning an associate degree in education from Walters State Community College in Morristown, Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. Rogers went on to earn a Bachelor of Science degree from East Tennessee State University and later a master's degree and an Education Specialist degree from Lincoln Memorial University; and

WHEREAS, from 1989 to 2003, Karen Rogers served as a project manager and grant writer with Douglas Cherokee, where she completed multimillion-dollar projects; she then transitioned to education from 2003 to 2019, teaching seventh-grade at East Ridge Middle School and then teaching at East High School; she devoted the last six years of her career to working with the First CORE office as a CTE consultant; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. Rogers received many awards and recognitions throughout her career, not only within her community but across the State; and

WHEREAS, Karen Rogers had a profound impact on her students and colleagues; she was an advocate for all students and ensured access to equitable opportunities to build a better future; her belief in others helped give her students the permission to think bigger; and

WHEREAS, along with her career in education, Mrs. Rogers had a passion for crafting and enjoyed serving in sales for seven years with Thirty-One; through this, she met many

people and developed several lifelong friendships, including Maureen "Mo" Reeves; whenever she was not working, she could be found making crafts or attending crafting events; and

WHEREAS, Karen Rogers was an active member of Fairview Baptist Church and will be remembered for her deep faith in Jesus Christ and love of her family and friends; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. Rogers is survived by her husband of forty-four years, Don A. Rogers; her son, Luke Rogers; her granddaughters, Laycie, Sadie, and Peyton; her mother, Charlotte W. Tolliver; her mother-in-law, Barbara Rogers; her brothers-in-law, Gary (Lisa) Rogers and Bill (Dawn) Rogers; her loving aunts, Norma Newman and Loretta Carrington; and her loyal supporter, Julia Lamons; and

WHEREAS, Karen Rogers was preceded in death by her father, Thomas P. Williford, Sr.; her brothers, Thomas P. Williford, Jr., and John Kelvin Williford; her grandparents, L.D. McCulley and Mildred McCulley and John and Kate Etter Williford; and her father-in-law, Billy Don Rogers; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we should pay tribute to her bountiful life of purpose and service; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, that we honor the memory of Karen D. Williford Rogers, reflecting fondly upon her impeccable character and her stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction. We express our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family and friends of Mrs. Rogers.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy.